

CASE ID: 202410710002

EPISODE NAME: China Sanctions US Firms over Arms Sales 2024

2024/10/10 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: End Weapons/Materials Proliferation (9)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On 2024/10/10, China sanctioned three companies and ten senior executives of the US defense industry. This action was in response to the US's \$567 million support package for Taiwan in 2024/09/29. The sanctions consisted of asset freezes, total import and export restrictions, and travel bans.

Narrative:

On 2024/10/10, China imposed sanctions on the US in response to arms sales to Taiwan.¹ This comes after US president Biden's \$567 million support package for Taiwan on 2024/09/29.² Although China's sanctions specifically target three US defense companies: Edge Autonomy Operations LLC, Huntington Ingalls Industries Inc. and Skydio Inc., and ten senior executives of US defense companies, the US's support package did not mention any specific companies, individuals, or goods involved.³

The initial onset of the episode began when China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs said: "This seriously violates the one-China principle and the three China-U.S. Joint Communiqués, interferes in China's internal affairs, and undermines China's sovereignty and territorial integrity".⁴ These bureaucratic sanctions were imposed by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, and consisted of an asset freeze and total import and export restriction for the companies and executives mentioned, as well as a travel ban for the executives mentioned.⁵

China's sanctions on the entities are still in effect.

¹ "Decision on Taking Countermeasures Against U.S. Military Companies and Senior Executives." *The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China*, October 20th, 2024.
www.mfa.gov.cn/mfa_eng/xw/wjbxw/202410/t20241011_11505419.html.

² "Memorandum on the Delegation of Authority Under Section 506(a)(3) of the Foreign Assistance Act of 1961." *The White House*, September 29th, 2024.
www.whitehouse.gov/briefing-room/presidential-actions/2024/09/29/memorandum-on-the-delegation-of-authority-under-section-506a3-of-the-foreign-assistance-act-of-1961-2/.

³ *Ibid.*

⁴ "Decision on Taking Countermeasures Against U.S. Military Companies and Senior Executives." *The Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China*, October 10th, 2024.
www.mfa.gov.cn/mfa_eng/xw/wjbxw/202410/t20241011_11505419.html.

⁵ *Ibid.*